

MEMORANDUM

July 16, 1943.

On Thursday, July 15th, there was discussed with Mr. White and Mr. Paul the proposal to allow certain financial transactions which would facilitate the evacuation of Jews from Rumania. The total amount of foreign exchange that would be involved is around \$170,000 which would be blocked in Switzerland until after the war and then paid, presumably to the persons furnishing the local currency in Rumania to facilitate the evacuation.

It was agreed by Paul, White, Luxford, DuBois and me that the Treasury should indicate to State that it would be willing to allow the transaction if the evacuation would thereby become possible but that we ought to state the matter in such a way to avoid making a precedent if the evacuation does not materialize, which is likely to be the case. Accordingly, on Friday, July 16th, I called Meltzer of State and worked out the following language to be used in a cable to Bern:

"We feel that Treasury approval will be forthcoming in view of humanitarian considerations involved provided no foreign exchange is made available during the war."

(Signed) J. A. Pehle

cc: Olsen, Luxford, Fox, Schmidt.